

Red Bull Kumite

A MARKETING PLAN

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

RedBull Kumite is the platform for a **unique** tournament for **Street Fighter 6**. In its boxing cage, 15 of the world's best players compete to become the **world's newest champion**.

We have marketed this year's **UK qualifiers Kumite** edition, with the **main goal** of driving ticket and participation **registration** as well as building **awareness** around the event.

Our event, located in **Manchester** will run for **4 months** and includes an integrated marketing campaign that targets both **players and watchers** using an omni-channel approach.

Through the use of a **video** announcement, an integrated **guerrilla marketing** campaign, **partnerships** with influencers, and **post-event** content, we will brand RedBull Kumite as a **must-see** event, offering an experience that **cannot be forgotten**, thereby making RedBull known as a **household name** in the fighting game community.

Using our original and creative campaign, we project that both the **digital** and **physical attendance** of our Kumite Manchester edition will **exceed** all expectations.

INTERNAL ANALYSIS



RED BULL ACCOUNTS

@redbull 

- 19M followers
- Average 62% engagement rate

@redbulluk 

- 636K followers
- \$7USD - \$79USD estimated earnings per post
- average number of likes per post: 1.9K
- growth rate: 265 followers a day

@RedBull 

- 528K followers on Twitch
- 10 421 average viewers

@RedBull 

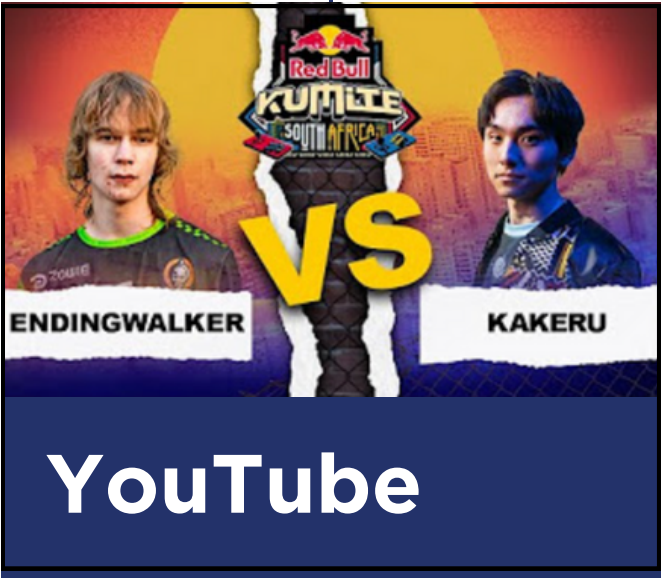
- Youtube channel with 13.5M subscribers, making it the #1 brand on the platform

The latest Kumite tournament in Pretoria garnered a total of **1.7M hours** watched, making this edition the most successful one by far. However, Red Bull's use of AI art for their promotional posts was at times contested, nonetheless, the majority of their marketing campaigns proved effective. Although an exact budget amount for the event was not disclosed to the public, the prize money for the 1st place was **US \$9000**, with smaller amounts being offered to those placed 2nd - 16th. Red Bull itself was the main funder of the event, and were assisted by companies like AGON, South African radio station TUKS.fm, Rocomamas and PlayStation who also sponsored the event.

Sources RedBull Channels (Instagram, Twitch, YouTube), Speakjr, Escharts, Gamerbraves, Red Bull website, TwitchTracker



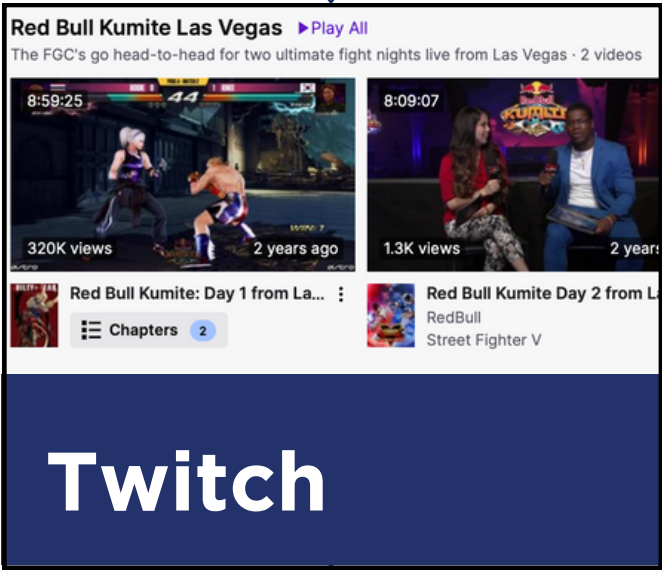
PREVIOUS MARKETING STRATEGIES



On YouTube, RedBull is the **#1 BRAND**
Mix of e-sport videos, mini-documentaries and live coverage of events. Thumbnails display competitive mood. Incorporation of ‘shorts’ that display game plays, challenges, funny moments, reactions, etc. which allow viewer to get to know players.



On Website, Instagram, Twitter and Facebook, RedBull uses **#REDBULLKUMITE** to engage viewers and invite earned media. Informative content is combined with live-updates, impressive gameplays, and influencer engagement to communicate the event to as many people as possible.



RedBull Twitch channel has **528K** followers. The Kumite event is streamed with live commentary. Streams are 8+ hours, and post-event highlights are posted. With various hyperlinks to other RedBull platforms.



Advertisement of national qualifier competition at local **SELLING POINTS** such as malls, event centres, supermarkets and billboards.

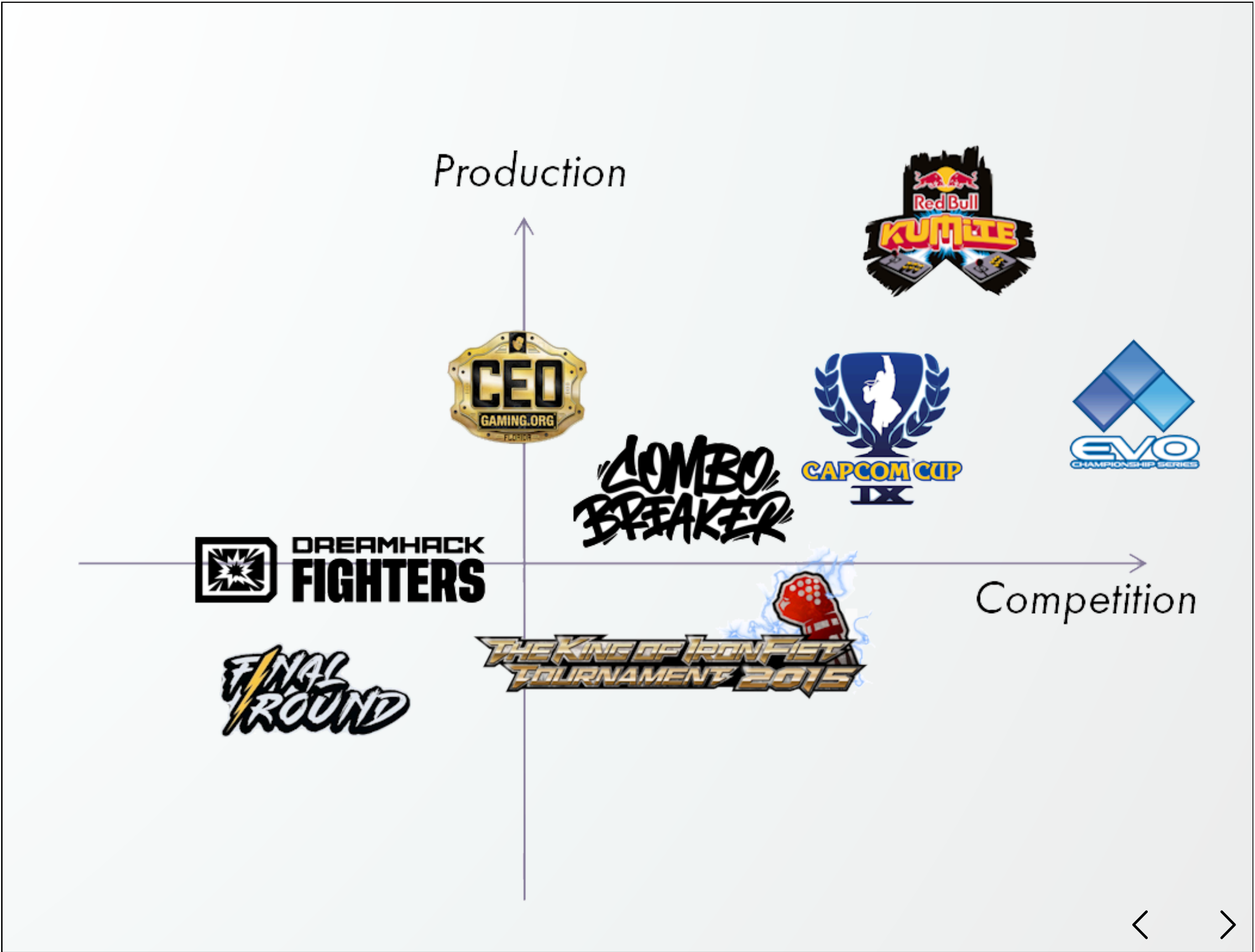


SITUATION ANALYSIS

RED BULL COMPETITORS

43%		Positions itself as a premium lifestyle brand synonymous with extreme sports and adventure , appealing to those who seek a fearless attitude and a blend of energy in their pursuits.
30%		Stands out with its vibrant and edgy persona, positioned at the intersection of action sports and youth culture, catering to individuals who crave not just an energy boost but an unapologetic and rebellious lifestyle.
10%		Carves its niche by aligning closely with music and gaming subcultures, positioning itself as a catalyst for inspiration and creativity in the dynamic worlds of festivals, gaming competitions, and artistic expression.

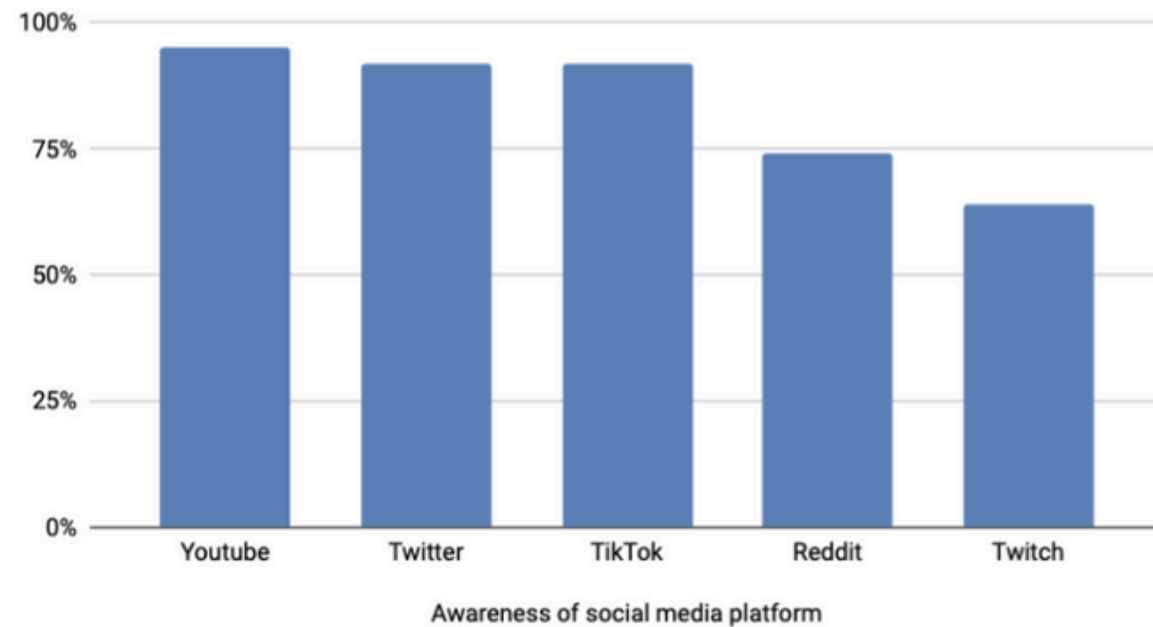
KUMITE COMPETITORS



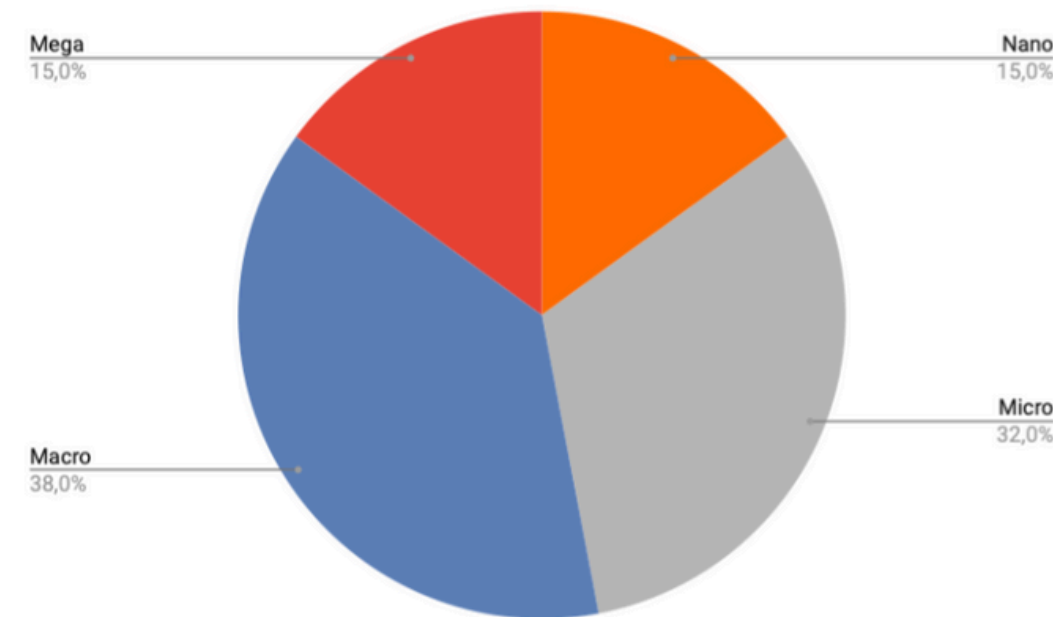
E-SPORTS MEDIA CHANNELS IN THE UK

UK 2022 Survey Data (Statista, 2022).

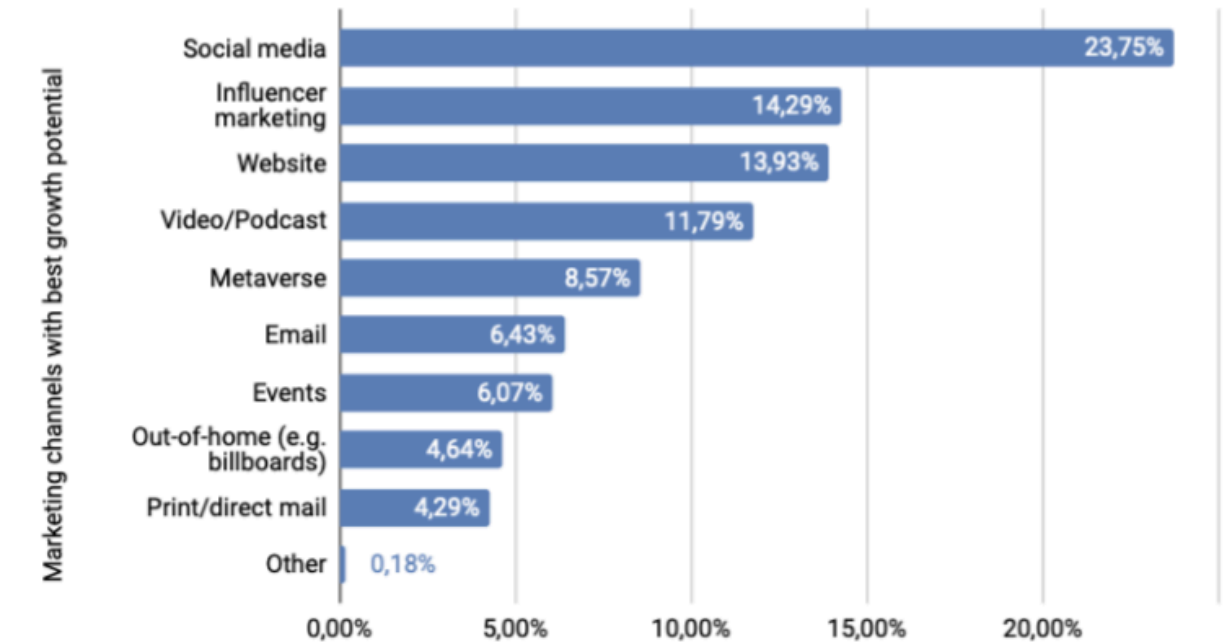
Leading social media platforms in the UK



Types of influencers with best B2C value in the UK



Marketing channels with highest growth potential in the UK



MAIN TAKEAWAYS

- **Youtube** is leading platform, **Twitter** and **TikTok** also frequently used
 - Youtube should thus be used for **generating awareness, gaining popularity, and building loyalty.**
- **Influencers** that have between **1000 and 1 million followers** (micro and macro) are the **biggest assets** to reach audiences in the UK
 - Video games influencer market: 14.14% of largest influencers in 2021.
- **Social media** is by far the **most promising strategy** to increase B2C value. Influencer marketing, website, and video/podcast marketing strategies are the next best things.
 - Potential marketing strategies should utilize this channel most.

INSIGHTS TARGET AUDIENCE

PRIMARY AND SECONDARY RESEARCH INSIGHTS

PLAYER BEHAVIOR

Among the survey respondents, 43% play E-games **four or more times each week**. The top three reasons to play an e-game were the community, the entertainment value, and the competition

WATCHER BEHAVIOR

75% of respondents watch competitions **online** and only 25% watch in person
The top three reasons to watch a competition were interest in the game, interest in the competition, and connecting with other gamers.

INFORMATION SOURCES

63% of respondents primarily use **social media** to discover new games and events, and **24%** rely on word of mouth.

KUMITE SPECIFIC

15% of respondents have watched the Kumite tournament. Among those, 43% heard about Kumite through **Social Media**. 71% most enjoyed the **ease of streaming and watching** events.

EVENT ATTENDANCE IN THE UK

31% of fighting game players have attended an event **online**, **15% in person**, and **48% have not attended** any events in the last 12 months. Online attendance is **higher for males**, and **Gen Z** and **Millenials** attend events more frequently than other age groups. Most people are **willing to pay £26-£50** for such events.

GAMING AND ESPORTS IN THE UK

Players of fighting games are **predominantly male**, and are **Gen Z** or **Millenials**. Over half of these fans **follow** and **eSports team**, and use the game on a **smartphone** (Statista, 2022).

FIGHTING
GAME /
ESPORTS
CONSUMERS



TARGET

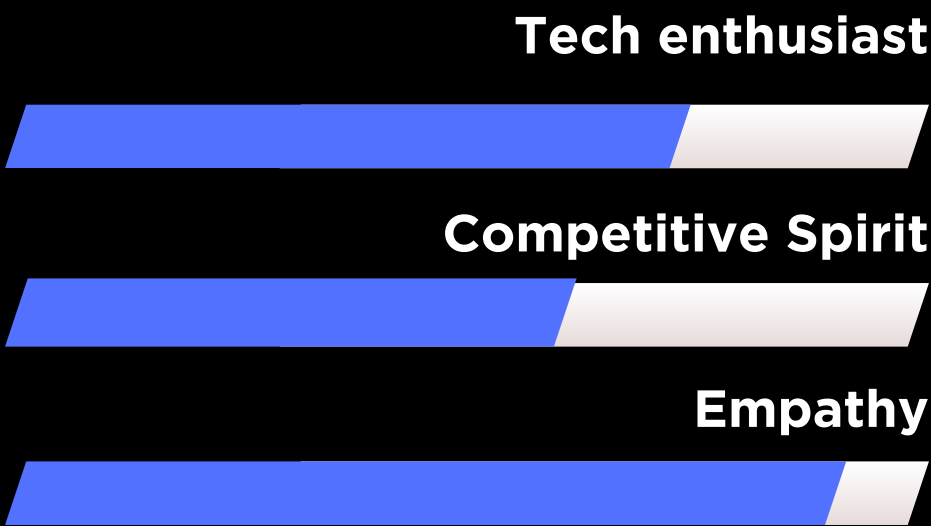
ABOUT

Our targets are gaming enthusiasts, like Alex. Alex's love for gaming was influenced by the vibrant UK gaming community. Alex actively participates in local gaming events, **staying connected** with the roots of a passion that began in Manchester's arcades.

MOTIVATIONS

- Global Recognition:** Aims to elevate the UK gaming scene globally.
- Local Talent Growth:** Contributes to the growth of local esports talent.
- Strategic Analysis:** Watches esports for strategic insights.

PERSONALITY



DESIRES

- Local Esports Growth
- Strategic Insights
- Community Engagement

Alex Mitchell

WATCHER



TARGET

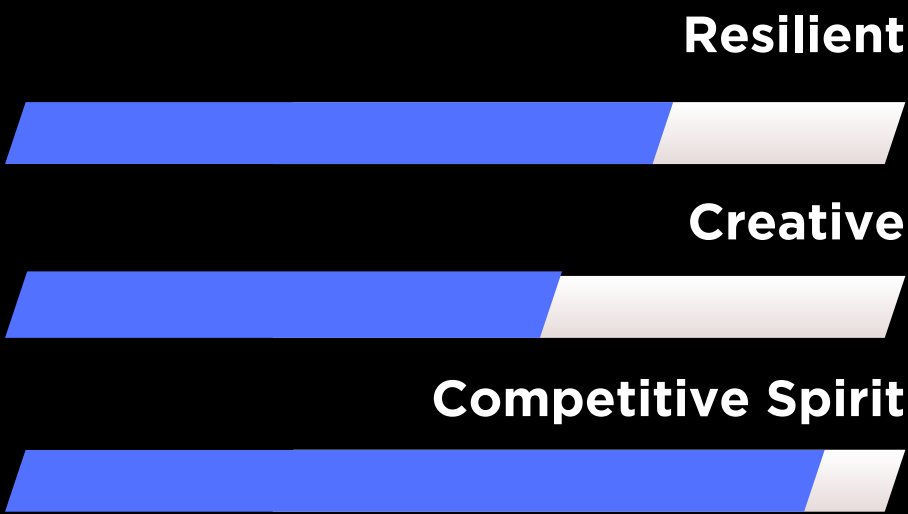
ABOUT

Our targets are like James - developed a passion for competitive gaming in his youth, finding joy and excitement in exploring virtual worlds and immersing himself in diverse gaming genres. Now employed at a Birmingham-based digital marketing agency, he aspires to integrate his professional life with his gaming enthusiasm.

MOTIVATIONS

- Validation:** Proving gaming is more than a hobby
- Opportunity:** Desire to showcase skills on a grand stage
- Persistence:** Despite limited experience, the dream of major gaming events fuels his motivation.

PERSONALITY



James Patel

PLAYER

DESIRES

- Recognition
- Winning
- Admiration





Red Bull Kumite 2024 - Manchester UNOFFICIAL



Share



Watch on YouTube

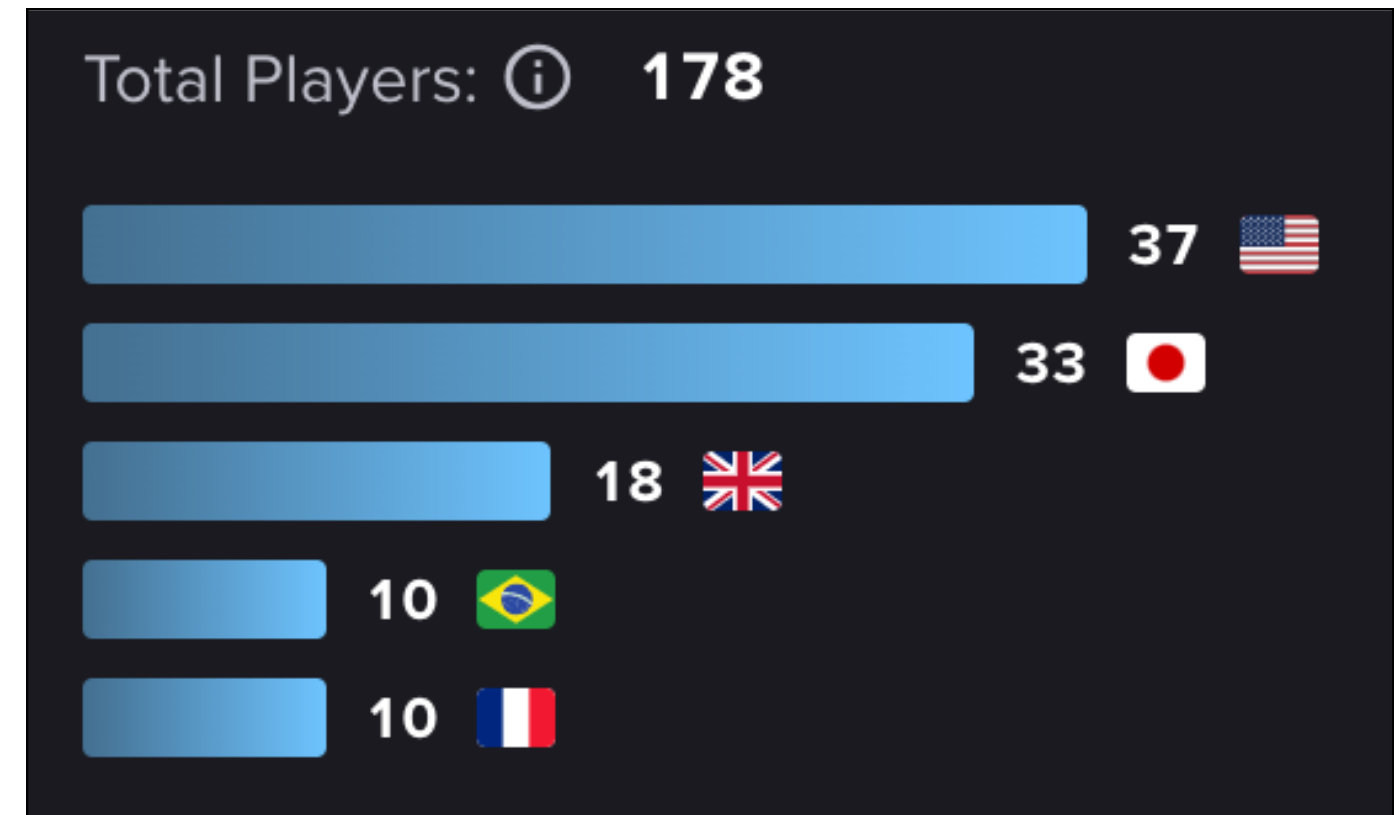
LOCATION & VENUE

Location: Manchester, UK

- One of the fastest growing markets in the gaming and esports industries
- Established and devoted fighting audience
- Third biggest by number of SF pro players.
 - After the US and Japan. Biggest in Europe.
- Precedent of Kumite events
 - Kumite London 2021

Venue: Manchester Central Convention Complex

- The venue's main hall can accommodate up to **4500** guests, which would make for the biggest Kumite final yet.
- Great for **hybrid gaming events** as it possesses a sophisticated plug and play solution that provides a professional interactive live streaming experience to engage its audience.



PARTNERSHIPS

The key partnership under consideration is **Ryan Hart**, a distinguished *micro fighting game player* known for streaming on Twitch. With his past collaboration at Kumite London 2021, there's a robust potential to draw his followers to RB's Twitch live stream for the event.



Additionally, a direct partnership with **TeamSoloMid (TSM)**, the world's most valuable esports organization valued at \$540 million by Forbes, holds significant promise. Given their successful prior engagements with Red Bull, the prospect for mutual gain is substantial.

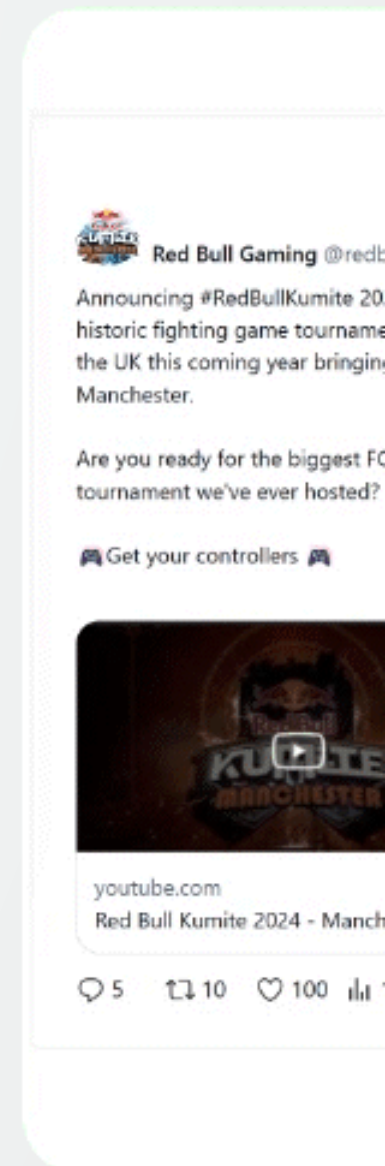
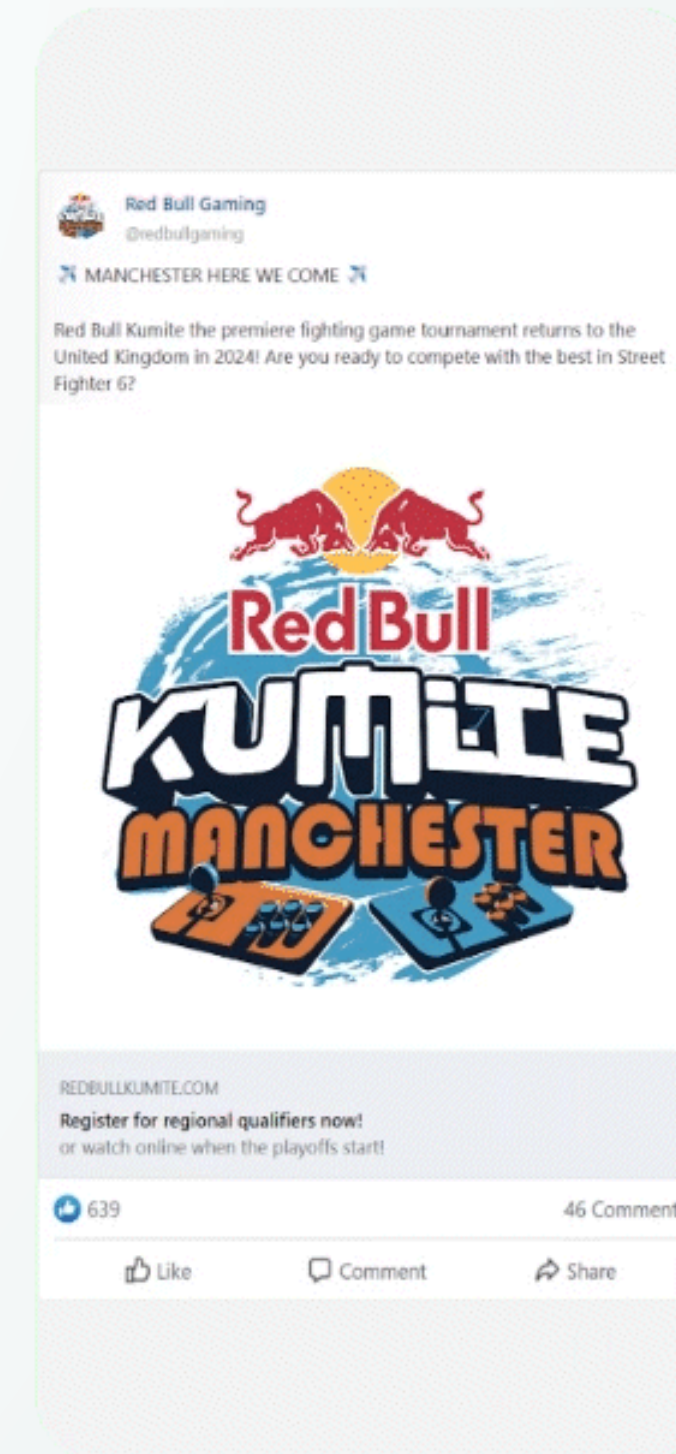
Involving **Tommy Fury**, the well-known Manchester *boxer*, is set to greatly boost event awareness. As a secondary partnership focusing on behind-the-scenes contributions, we expect substantial benefits from his local popularity and the heightened attention he brings to the event.



SOCIAL MEDIA MARKETING

Through cross-promotions on social media, podcast sponsorships, customized graphics, exclusive content, and influencer marketing, Red Bull ensures an **omnipresent** and **immersive** experience for both players and watchers, crafting an unparalleled esports spectacle.

Instagram offers **lucrative** visuals; TikTok adds **dynamism**, Reddit fosters deep community **engagement**. On Facebook, targeted ads and event pages heighten **visibility**. Integrating with gaming podcasts further **amplifies** the campaign.



GUERRILLA MARKETING ARCADE MACHINES

PLAYER AND WATCHER

Omni channel marketing strategy:

- 4 in-person arcade machines - experience-based, so enable trial and increase awareness. In biggest cities in the UK (e.g. London, Manchester, Birmingham, Leeds)
- **Social media plan:** RedBullUK accounts advertise RB Kumite Manchester through 'scavenger hunt'. The campaign posts give visual clues about location of the machines. Influencers will be used to promote the hunt. Participants are invited to post about it using **#RBKumiteManchester**
- **Gamification** element + **operant conditioning** mechanism: highest score across all machines can win chance to compete and attend the event, which will incentivise participation.
- **Target audience:** guerrilla marketing style creates **AWARENESS** of Kumite event amongst Red Bull lovers and random bypasses - thereby increasing RB's reach to new customers.
- Peaks **INTEREST** of both players and watches - as the machines facilitate trial of the game. It allows for testimonials, engagement and it is an unconventional technique - inviting unpaid media.
- Urge participants towards **DESIRE** of getting the tickets to participate - as the tickets that come out after the game is played **call** the participants **to action** to buy tickets or register to participate through a QR code.

AWARENESS

INTEREST

DESIRE

ACTION



ACTION ACCELERATORS

FIRST STRIKE ADVANTAGE

First 2 registrations win exclusive Red Bull headphones!



"FIRST STRIKE ADVANTAGE"

PLAYER

Red Bull **headphones** as an exclusive item for 2 **upcoming players** who register within the first 48 hours. Crafted for excellence, these headphones not only align with Red Bull's dynamic brand but also serve as a confidence-boosting gear, letting upcoming players feel like pros. A piece that addresses barriers, it echoes RB's commitment to fostering early engagement in the thriving esports community. Plus, players get to keep them as a lasting token.

PLAYER INVITATIONS

PLAYER

Extend **exclusive invitations** to esteemed players with personalized notes and a bespoke PR package, showcasing a **commitment to excellence**. The package includes tournament highlights, special insights, and a personalized token of appreciation. Welcoming these players to not only compete but to contribute in making Kumite an **unforgettable** gaming **spectacle**.

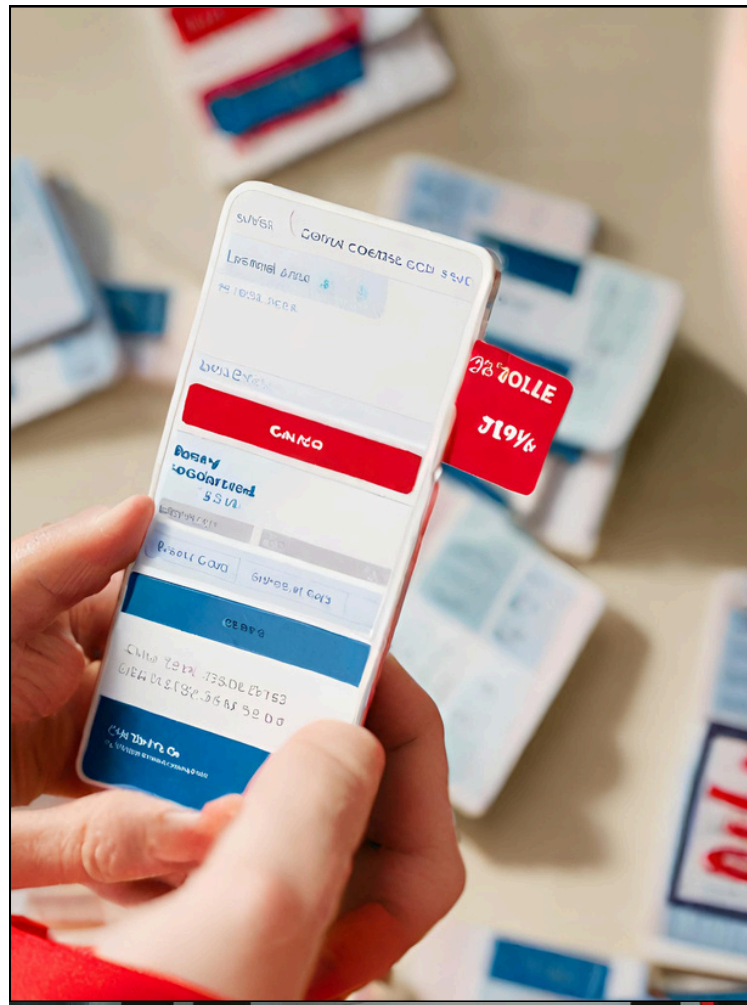


ELEVATING VIEWER ENGAGEMENT

WATCHER

Introduce special discount and referral codes for viewers, enhancing their experience and encouraging active participation. This initiative fosters a sense of **community** and **enthusiasm**, driving increased **engagement** and brand loyalty

- **Early Bird Discount:** Register within the first 48 hours for a limited-time 15% off your entry fee.
- **Referral Rewards:** Invite friends using your unique code. Both you and your friends get a 10% discount when they register..



PRO-VIEW

WATCHER

The first three viewers to register with code **KUMITEPROTRAIN** can **win** a training session with pro players. This offers unique insights, aiming to boost viewership and create heightened **anticipation**. Passionate community enthusiasts and pro player supporters can seize this chance to witness their **idols** and immerse in **excitement** with Red Bull. Synonymous with **excellence**, Red Bull elevates viewers, crafting an unparalleled esports spectacle.



BUILDING LONG-TERM LOYALTY

ADVOCACY



Player Mentorship Program

Successful past players are paired up with emerging players to **mentor** and guide them through the entire Kumite competition experience. This program builds loyalty among existing players and builds a **sense of community** around RedBull Kumite.



Follow-Up Digital Strategy

Tailor a post-event **digital strategy** to the players through individual highlight reels, follow-up feedback forms, and social media features. This strategy ensures strong digital engagement post-event and ensures players remember their **personalized and engaging experience** playing at Kumite.



Kumite Elite Wings Club

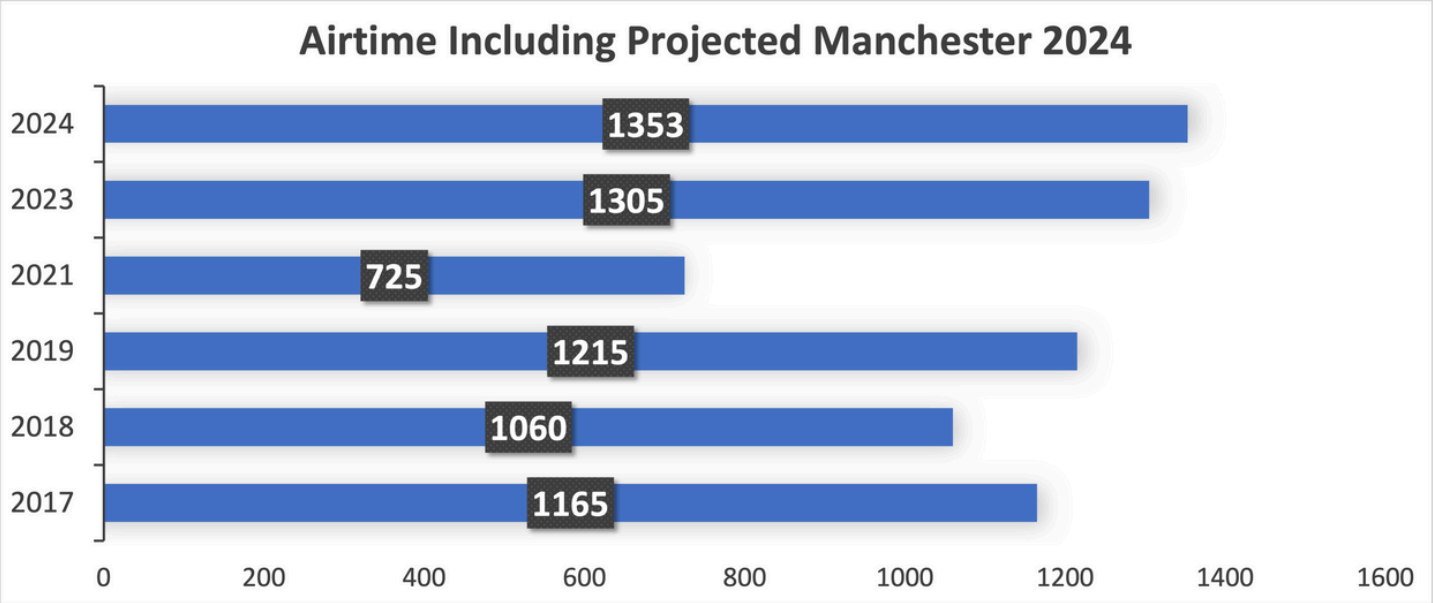
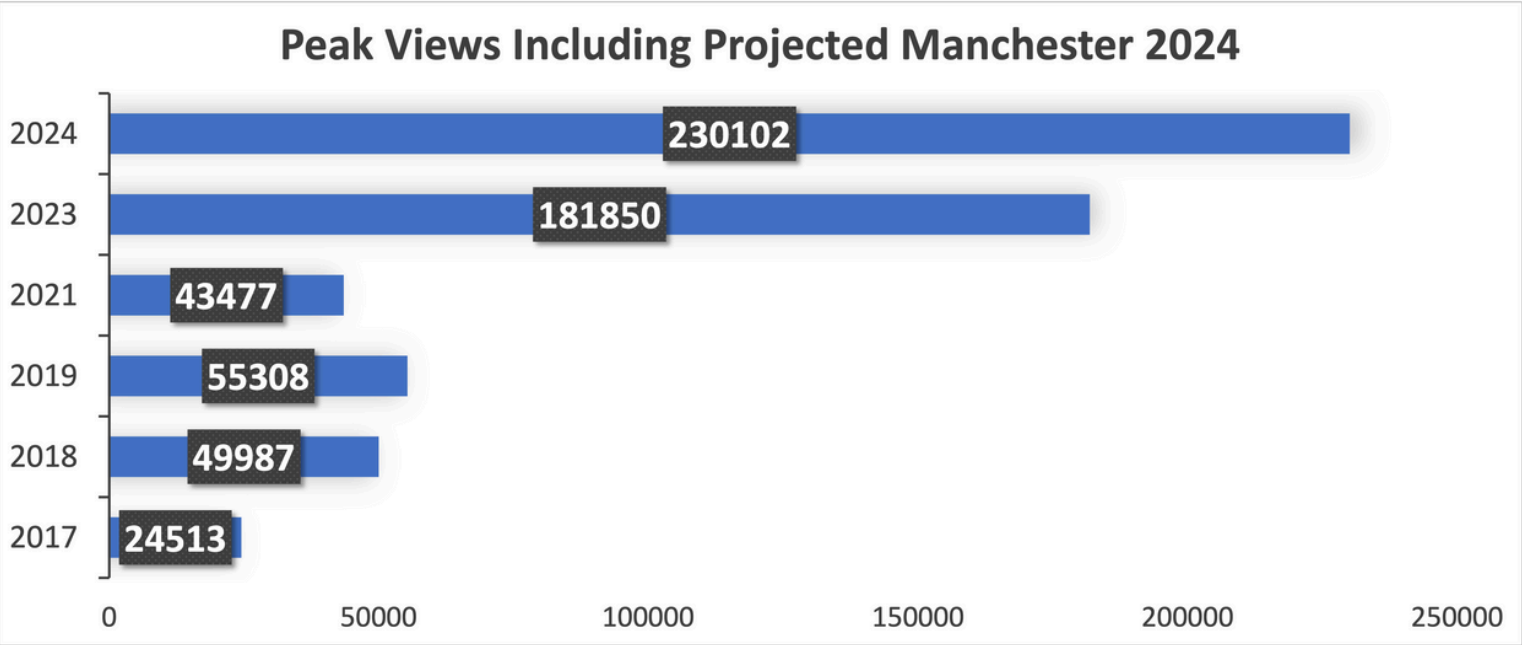
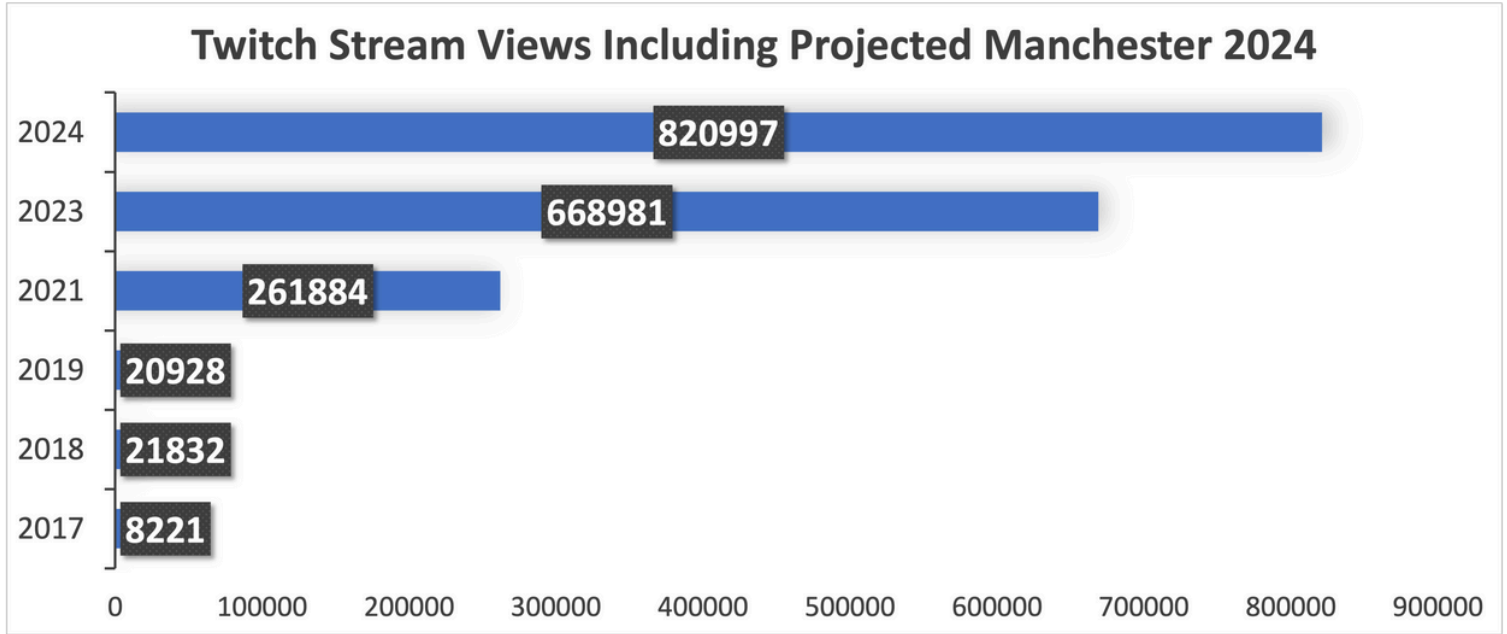
A tiered system not only **rewards successful watcher referrals** but also offers points for engaging activities like predicting match outcomes and participating in live chats. As points accumulate, participants unlock **escalating prizes**—ranging from limited-edition merchandise to VIP access at future Kumite events.



Kumite Recap Livestream

Host an electrifying **Recap Night**, where watchers **relive the adrenaline-pumping highlights** of the epic Kumite event. As a follow-up event, recap night continues to generate strong loyalty around Kumite while **building excitement** for the following year.

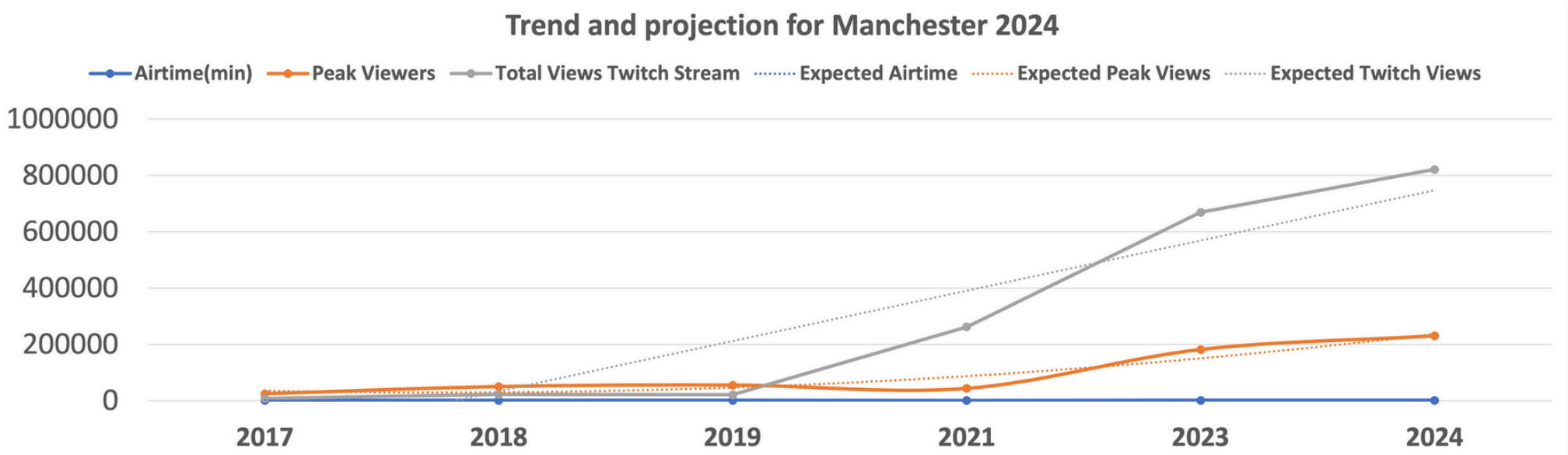
VIEWERSHIP ANALYTICS



We used the data gathered for the RB Kumite finals to run predictions on air time, total stream views and peak views we expect to reach during our event.

INSIGHTS

- Stream views will likely continue to linearly increase
 - Follow airtime minutes. **Longer streams** tend to draw **more views** over time.
- Peak views have increased **exponentially**
 - Due to sustained and combined growth in the gaming, esports, and energy drink industries.
- Massive growth seen in Pretoria, 2023 (*181k peak*)
- Even **higher views expected** in 2024 (*230k peak*)
 - Europe-centric event activates larger player bases
 - More accessible location and stream



data available at <https://escharts.com/tournaments?>

SUCCESS FACTORS



Quality of Competition: The presence of top-tier players and a well-structured tournament format can draw attention and maintain engagement throughout the event.



Production Value: High-quality streaming, engaging commentary, and an appealing venue will enhance the viewer experience and maintain Kumite’s positioning as high-production.



Community Engagement: Involvement of the gaming community through interactive elements, fan meet-ups, and opportunities for attendees to participate can amplify the event’s impact.



Innovation and Uniqueness: Incorporating new elements, surprises, or unique features into the event can set it apart and generate excitement among both players and viewers.



Brand Association and Promotion: Leveraging the Red Bull brand effectively in promotions and creating a buzz through marketing efforts can significantly contribute to the event’s success.



INTEGRATED MARKETING COMMUNICATION SCHEDULE

The IMC schedule outlines the marketing campaign roll-out over a **six-month timeline**.

Aligned with the Kumite announcement in December/January, many strategies such as an introductory video and personalized invitations help **generate awareness** around Kumite.

During the qualifier phase in January/February, guerrilla marketing and other strategies **convert interest into action** driving registration and ticket sales. Lastly, for the national final event and beyond, strategies such as mentorship programs and a recap night in the months following the final continue to **build Kumite loyalty**.

Announcement						
Qualifier Phase						
National Final						
Red Bull Kumite IMC Schedule	DEC	JAN	FEB	MAR	APR	MAY
Paid Media:						
Partnerships						
First Strike Advantage						
Player Invitations						
Guerrilla Arcade Machines						
Player Mentorship Program						
Kumite Recap Night						
Owned Media:						
Video						
Kumite Elite Wings Club						
Digital Strategy						
Earned Media:						
Referrals						



**Thank you
for your time!**
QUESTIONS?



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